

Gamification in Education 2026 — 2-day teacher-training course

A redesigned, updated version of the gamification seminar Kevin Storm delivered via GEC Academy at Mediacollege Amsterdam (2023 and 2024, part of the Erasmus+ "Digi-Eng" project) for international teacher groups. Same proven 2-day, hands-on, train-the-teacher format. Updated for 2026 with AI, gamedesign, VR/AR, and a strong inclusion / special-needs lens.

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1. Course at a glance

- **Format:** 2 full days (approx. 09:30–16:30), in person; also deliverable as 4 half-day online modules for remote/Erasmus-hybrid groups.
 - **Audience:** teachers and teacher-trainers (primary, secondary, vocational, special education), international groups welcome. No coding or gaming background required.
 - **Group size:** 8–20 (sweet spot 12–16).
 - **Language:** English (Dutch on request).
 - **Certification:** Certificate of completion + Europass/Erasmus+ learning outcomes mapping (so KA1 participants can validate mobility).
 - **What each teacher leaves with:** one ready-to-run gamified lesson or unit of their own, a personal toolkit, and the confidence to keep building.
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2. Promise / positioning (the one-liner)

"In two days you stop *hearing about* gamification and start *building* it — a real, playable lesson for your own classroom, that works for every learner, including the ones who usually check out."

3. Learning outcomes

By the end, participants can:

1. Explain the difference between ****gamification, game-based learning, and serious games****, and pick the right one for a given goal.
2. Apply core mechanics (goals, feedback, progression, challenge, autonomy, meaning) to an existing lesson without dumbing down the content.

3. Design and run a **gamified lesson or unit** aligned to their curriculum.
 4. Use **AI tools** to design, differentiate, and produce game materials fast.
 5. Build a simple interactive artefact (a branching game, a quest, or an AR/VR or stop-motion element) with no-code / low-code tools.
 6. **Adapt** mechanics for special-needs and mixed-ability groups so no learner is left out.
 7. Assess learning inside a gamified format (so it is real teaching, not just fun) and avoid the common pitfalls (points-only, extrinsic-only, burnout).
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4. Updates vs. the 2023/2024 version (what's new for 2026)

- **AI woven through the whole course** — from idea generation to producing images, quests, NPC dialogue, rubrics, and differentiated versions in minutes.
 - **Vibe-coding / no-code building** — teachers make a small working tool or game, not just a paper plan (ties to Kevin's current AI-tool work).
 - **Inclusion module upgraded** — explicit strategies for special needs, drawing on Kevin's SO/VSO work (stopmotion with multiple disabilities, high-autonomy learners).
 - **Intrinsic-motivation depth** — Self-Determination Theory (autonomy, competence, relatedness) made practical, to counter shallow points-and-badges.
 - **AR/VR kept but lightened** — a taste of immersive tech that any school can actually afford and run.
 - **Sustainability & transfer** — how to keep it going after the course, and how a trainer cascades it to a whole team (train-the-trainer layer).
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5. Toolkit (all free or low-cost, cross-platform)

- **Design & AI:** ChatGPT/Claude, an image generator, a rubric/quiz generator.
 - **No-code game/interactive:** Twine (branching narrative), Genially / classic quest boards, Kahoot/Blooket/Gimkit (quiz layer), Flippity, Minecraft Education (optional), Scratch (optional).
 - **Immersive / media:** CoSpaces or a simple AR app; stop-motion app; a phone camera. (Kevin's crossover: media-making as a game mechanic.)
 - **Classroom systems:** Classcraft-style progression, XP/level sheets, narrative framing templates provided as handouts.
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6. DAY 1 — Foundations + first build

Block 1 (09:30–10:45) · Why games work

- Warm welcome + a live gamified icebreaker (participants experience mechanics before they name them).
- The core question: what actually drives engagement? Intrinsic vs extrinsic.
- Gamification vs game-based learning vs serious games — clear, with examples.
- Myth-busting: why "just add points and badges" fails.

Break 10:45–11:00

Block 2 (11:00–12:30) · The mechanics toolbox

- The 6 levers: clear goals, fast feedback, visible progression, right-sized challenge (flow), autonomy/choice, meaning/story.
- Guided teardown: take a boring standard lesson and re-engineer it live.
- Hands-on: participants map one of their own lessons onto the levers.

Lunch 12:30–13:30

Block 3 (13:30–15:00) · Build with AI (fast)

- Live demo: from a curriculum objective to a playable quest in ~15 minutes using AI (story, tasks, images, hints, differentiated versions).
- Hands-on: each teacher generates the skeleton of their own gamified lesson.
- Prompting patterns handout (reusable after the course).

Break 15:00–15:15

Block 4 (15:15–16:30) · Make it real (no-code)

- Choose a track: branching game (Twine), quest board (Genially), or quiz-driven progression (Blooket/Gimkit).
- Teachers build a first working prototype of their lesson.
- Quick gallery walk + peer feedback. Homework prompt: one improvement idea.

7. DAY 2 — Inclusion, immersion, and delivery

Block 5 (09:30–10:45) · Gamification for every learner (inclusion)

- Kevin's core edge: designing for kids who fall outside the standard picture.
- Strategies for special needs & mixed ability: adjustable challenge, non-verbal win-states, choice as regulation, sensory load, collaboration vs competition.
- Case stories: stopmotion with multiple-disability learners; high-autonomy settings (e.g. Agora-style). Participants adapt their prototype for inclusion.

Break 10:45–11:00

Block 6 (11:00–12:30) · Immersive & media as mechanics

- Light-touch AR/VR and stop-motion as game elements any school can run.
- Hands-on: add one immersive or media "moment" to a lesson (a scan-to-unlock clue, an AR object, a stop-motion cutscene).

Lunch 12:30–13:30

Block 7 (13:30–15:00) · Assessment, motivation & pitfalls

- How to assess real learning inside a game format (evidence, not just points).
- Self-Determination Theory made practical; designing for intrinsic motivation.
- Avoiding burnout, unhealthy competition, and equity traps.
- Teachers add an assessment layer to their lesson.

Break 15:00–15:15

Block 8 (15:15–16:30) · Play, feedback, transfer & certificates

- Mini play-test carousel: teachers play each other's lessons and give structured feedback.
 - Transfer plan: how to run it Monday, and (for trainers) how to cascade it to a whole team — the train-the-trainer layer.
 - Reflection, learning-outcomes check, certificates, next steps.
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8. The through-line project (what makes it stick)

From Day 1 Block 2 to Day 2 Block 8, every teacher carries **one real lesson of their own** through each stage: mapped → AI-drafted → built → made inclusive → made immersive → assessable → play-tested. They leave with a finished, usable thing, not notes. This is the reason the original course landed so well — keep it.

9. Assessment & certification

- Completion based on: participation + a finished gamified lesson + a short reflection.
 - Provide a **learning-outcomes / competences sheet** mapped to Erasmus+ so KA1 participants can validate their mobility, plus a certificate template.
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10. Follow-up & upsell (turns a course into a relationship)

- 30-day "keep playing" email sequence with one nudge per week.
- Optional online follow-up clinic (paid) 4–6 weeks later.
- Team/school licence: bring the whole team, Kevin trains the trainers.

- Natural bridge to Kevin's other services: curriculum/leerlijn design and in-house teamtrainingen.
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11. Facilitator notes (Kevin's delivery style)

- Experience first, name second: make them feel a mechanic before defining it.
 - Keep it low-threshold: no coding assumed; everyone builds something day one.
 - Use real classrooms, not theory: your special-needs stories are the differentiator — lead with them, they are what people remember.
 - Timings are a scaffold, not a cage; protect the build blocks above all.
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12. Logistics checklist

- Room with tables for group work, projector, reliable wifi.
 - Participants bring a laptop; a few tablets/phones for AR & stop-motion.
 - Accounts set up in advance (AI tool, Twine/Genially, quiz tool).
 - Printed handouts: mechanics map, prompting patterns, inclusion strategies, XP/level & narrative templates, certificate.
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Next steps we can build on top of this: a slide deck, the printable handout

pack, a one-page course flyer/sales sheet for GEC or other Erasmus+ providers, and an online (4x half-day) version.*